Jesse McDevitt-Irwin

Collegiate Assistant Professor, University of Chicago
Harper-Schmidt Fellow, Society of Fellows in the Liberal Arts
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Academic Positions

Collegiate Assistant Professor, Social Sciences Division, University of Chicago *2025–2029*
Harper-Schmidt Fellow, Society of Fellows in the Liberal Arts

Postdoctoral Scholar, Center for Economic History, Northwestern University *2024–2025*

Education

Ph.D., Sustainable Development, Columbia University *2024*

M.A., Economics, University of British Columbia *2017*

B.A., Applied Economics, Queen's University *2016*

Publications

McDevitt-Irwin, Jesse, and James R. Irwin. "Infant Mortality among US Whites in the 19th Century: New Evidence from Childhood Sex Ratios." *Demographic Research* 52: 303–350. *2025*

McDevitt-Irwin, Jesse. "Child Anemia and the 2008 Food Price Crisis in Senegal." *Demographic Research* 51: 637–668. *2024*

Working Papers

López Araiza, Sergio, and Jesse McDevitt-Irwin. "The Hidden Costs of Mass Deportations: Early-Life Mortality and the 1930s Mexican Repatriation." *October 2026*

Works in Progress

"Comparing the JMP Drinking Water Ladder and HWISE Scale in the 2022–23 Mozambique DHS." With Indira Bose, Joshua Miller and Sera Young.

"Sex Ratio at Birth and the HIV Epidemic in South Africa." With Jenny Trinitapoli.

"Black Health in Slavery and Freedom: New Evidence from Childhood Sex Ratios." With James R. Irwin.

"The Industrialization Puzzle in the US: New Evidence from Childhood Sex Ratios."

Research Infrastructure

Historical African Census Digitization Project *2026–*
Construction of a harmonized dataset from published African census reports, 1950–present, extracted from scanned PDF sources. Research assistant: Maria Coca.

Invited Talks

European Society of Historical Demography *December 2025*

Presentations

Water and Health Conference, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (poster) *2026*

Social Science History Association *2025*

Northwestern Economic History Seminar *2024*

Population Association of America, Annual Meeting *2023*

Northwestern Economic History Workshop *2023*

University of Chicago Demography Workshop *2023*

Canadian Economic Association, Canadian Network of Economic History *2021, 2022*

Awards and Fellowships

Harper-Schmidt Fellow, Society of Fellows in the Liberal Arts, University of Chicago *2025–2029*

SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship *2021–2023*

Wu Fellowship, Columbia University *2018–2019*

Dean's Fellow, Columbia University *2018–2023*

Teaching

University of Chicago — Collegiate Assistant Professor *2025–*

SOSC 16100 / 16200 / 16300, Global Society. Three-quarter Core social sciences sequence; two sections per year. Culminates in an independent research project with a 6,000-word paper.

University of Chicago — Lecturer *2023–2024*

SOSC 16300, Global Society III.

Northwestern University — Lecturer *2025*

ECON 323-2, Economic History of the United States since 1865. 62 students; designed from scratch. US demographic history using IPUMS full-count census microdata and R.

ANT 390, Methods in Global Health. Seminar, co-taught with Sera Young; led the R instruction.

Service and Professional Activity

Discussant, Canadian Economic Association Conference, Canadian Network of Economic History *2022*

President, Sustainable Development Doctoral Society, Columbia University *2020–2021*

Member, Population Association of America; Social Science History Association

Affiliations

Population Research Center, University of Chicago *2025–*

Center for Economic History, Northwestern University *2023–*

West African Research Center, Dakar, Senegal *2022*

Technical and Language Skills

R; historical census microdata, Demographic and Health Surveys, historical vital statistics

English (native); French (fluent); Spanish (B2); Wolof (intermediate)